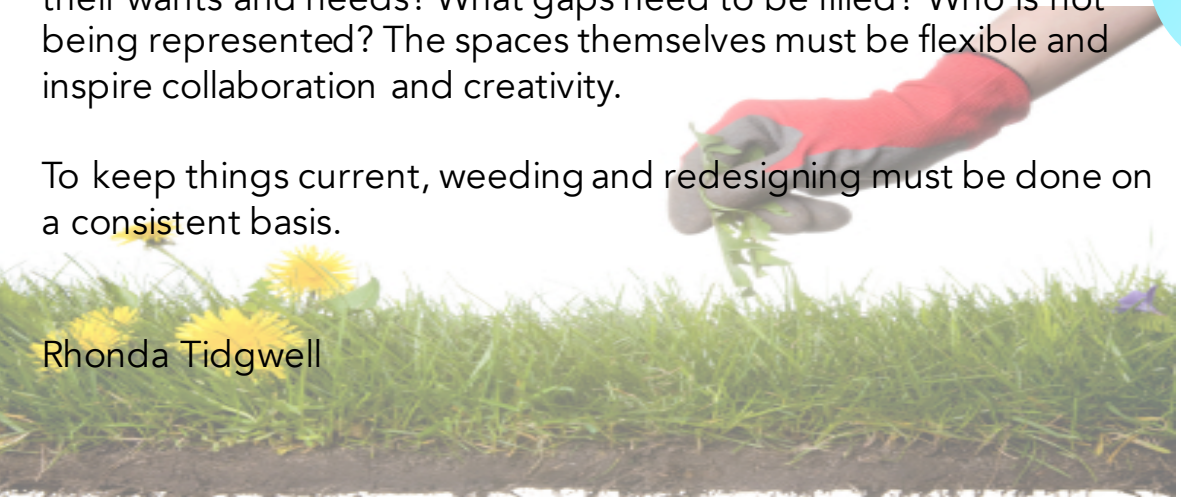
Out with the old, in with the new: Weeding & Redesigning the Space

To keep the learning commons current and purposeful, **weeding** and redesigning is essential. Why?

"Because every school should be changing all the time. And should be changing with a purpose – moving from adult centered teaching spaces to child centered learning spaces – moving from static environments to flexible environments – moving from controlling design to inspiring design." –Ira David Socal, *How Will You Redesign Your School Over The Next Six Months?* (2017)

It all comes down to relevance. Materials, and spaces, in a school must reflect current thinking, attitudes, interests, and the community themselves. Students need to be able to see themselves in the materials provided. Weeding can also promote collaboration. We can ask students and staff for input. What are their wants and needs? What gaps need to be filled? Who is not being represented? The spaces themselves must be flexible and inspire collaboration and creativity.

To keep things current, weeding and redesigning must be done on a consistent basis.



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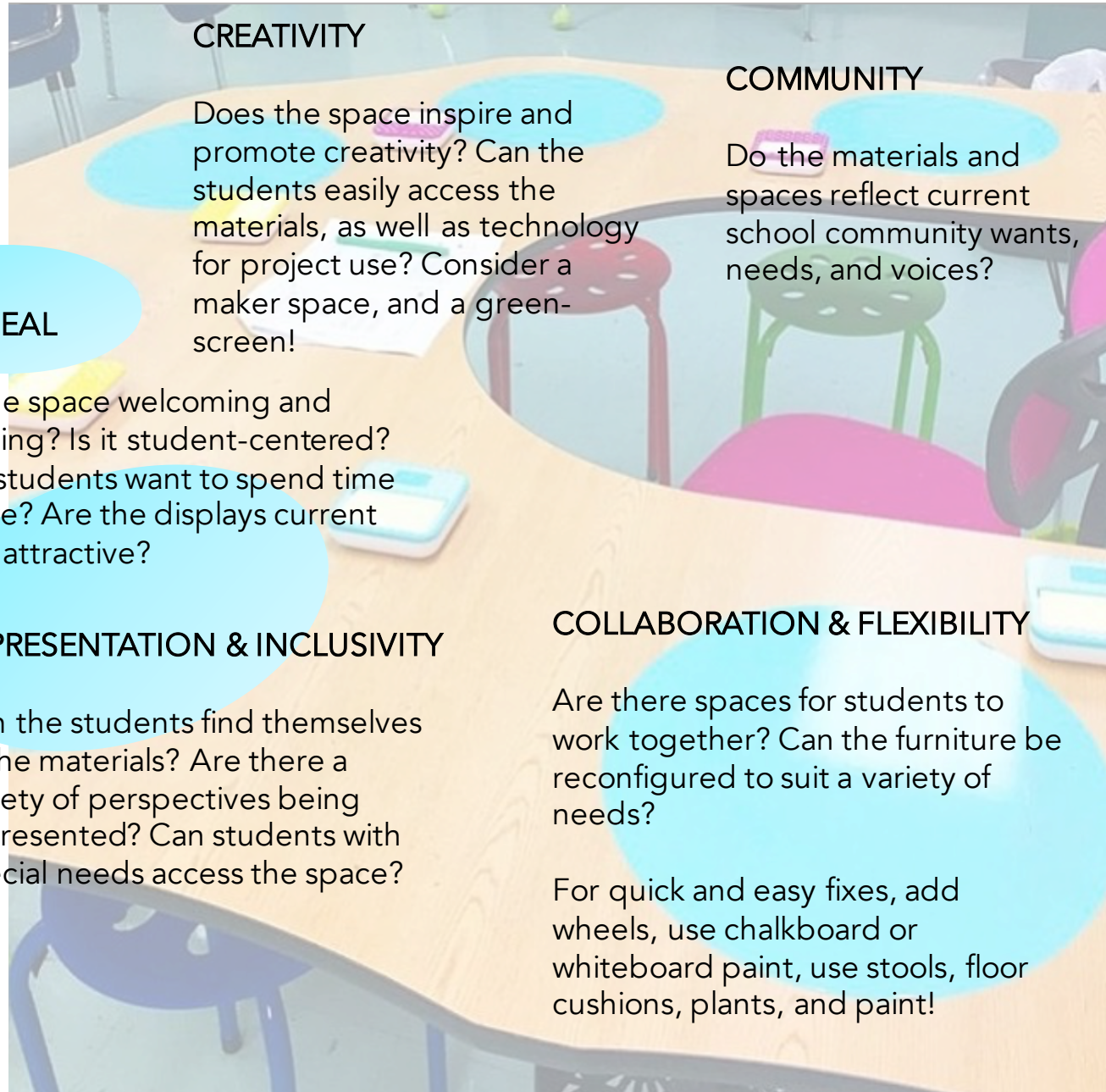

CREATIVITY

Does the space inspire and promote creativity? Can the students easily access the materials, as well as technology for project use? Consider a maker space, and a green-screen!

COMMUNITY

Do the materials and spaces reflect current school community wants, needs, and voices?

APPEAL

Is the space welcoming and inviting? Is it student-centered? Do students want to spend time there? Are the displays current and attractive?

REPRESENTATION & INCLUSIVITY

Can the students find themselves in the materials? Are there a variety of perspectives being represented? Can students with special needs access the space?

COLLABORATION & FLEXIBILITY

Are there spaces for students to work together? Can the furniture be reconfigured to suit a variety of needs?

For quick and easy fixes, add wheels, use chalkboard or whiteboard paint, use stools, floor cushions, plants, and paint!